FIGURE 15.1: THERMOSTAT LEADERSHIP VS THERMOMETER REACTION

Emotional Contagion vs. Calibrated Nervous System Regulation

THE THERMOMETER LEADER

(Passive, Reactive Mirror)

- Reflects and amplifies the room's panic
- When alarms scream, their voice spikes
- Demands absolute perfection through fear
- Shuts down vulnerability & dissent
- Staff conceal errors out of self-defence
- High turnover, moral injury, burnout

CULTURE EFFECT:

A chaotic ward of terrified technicians

★ THE THERMOSTAT LEADER

(Active, Calibrating Anchor)

- Senses the room's heat and adjusts climate
- Absorbs chaotic turbulence, radiates calm
- Speaks with unhurried, grounded cadence
- Amy Edmondson psychological safety
- Staff report near-misses immediately
- Mutual protection; carriers are carried

CULTURE EFFECT:

A resilient, unshakeable constellation